

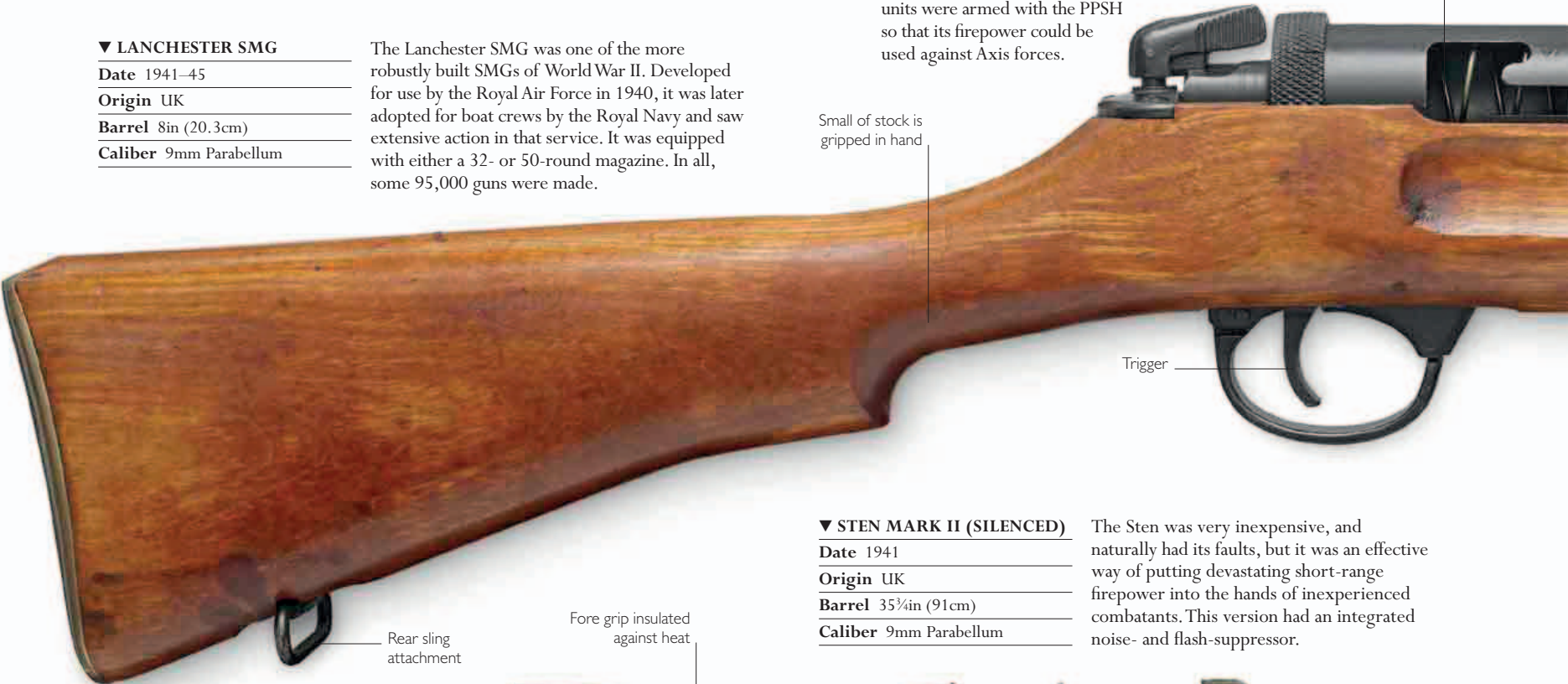
EUROPEAN SUBMACHINE-GUNS (1939–45)

The submachine-gun (SMG) was one of World War II’s primary offensive weapons. Light in weight and capable of delivering a massive amount of fire if needed, the submachine-gun was favored by shock troops and those operating in cramped quarters. Soviet forces used the PPSH-41 in extensive numbers when attacking, simply because of the volume of fire it could deliver against enemy formations.

▼ LANCHESTER SMG

Date	1941–45
Origin	UK
Barrel	8in (20.3cm)
Caliber	9mm Parabellum

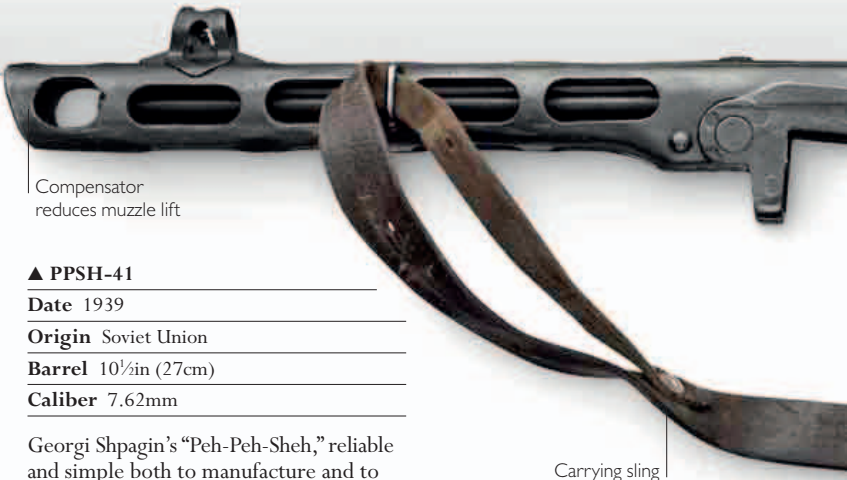
The Lanchester SMG was one of the more robustly built SMGs of World War II. Developed for use by the Royal Air Force in 1940, it was later adopted for boat crews by the Royal Navy and saw extensive action in that service. It was equipped with either a 32- or 50-round magazine. In all, some 95,000 guns were made.



▲ PPSH-41

Date	1939
Origin	Soviet Union
Barrel	10½in (27cm)
Caliber	7.62mm

Georgi Shpagin’s “Peh-Peh-Sheh,” reliable and simple both to manufacture and to maintain, was to become the mainstay of the Red Army after it stopped the German advance into the Soviet Union. At least five million examples of this sturdy weapon had been produced by 1945. During World War II, entire units were armed with the PPSH so that its firepower could be used against Axis forces.



Small of stock is gripped in hand

Mainspring

Trigger

▼ STEN MARK II (SILENCED)

Date	1941
Origin	UK
Barrel	35¾in (91cm)
Caliber	9mm Parabellum

The Sten was very inexpensive, and naturally had its faults, but it was an effective way of putting devastating short-range firepower into the hands of inexperienced combatants. This version had an integrated noise- and flash-suppressor.



Magazine port

Pressed and stamped steel body

Breech bolt

Rear sight

Fixed steel butt



▲ STEN MARK II

Date	1941
Origin	UK
Barrel	7¾in (19.7cm)
Caliber	9mm

Cheap and easy to manufacture, the Sten Mark II was a stop-gap weapon that was to prove itself an effective submachine-gun. The gun was fitted with a 32-round magazine.